Casemiro Replacement Profile

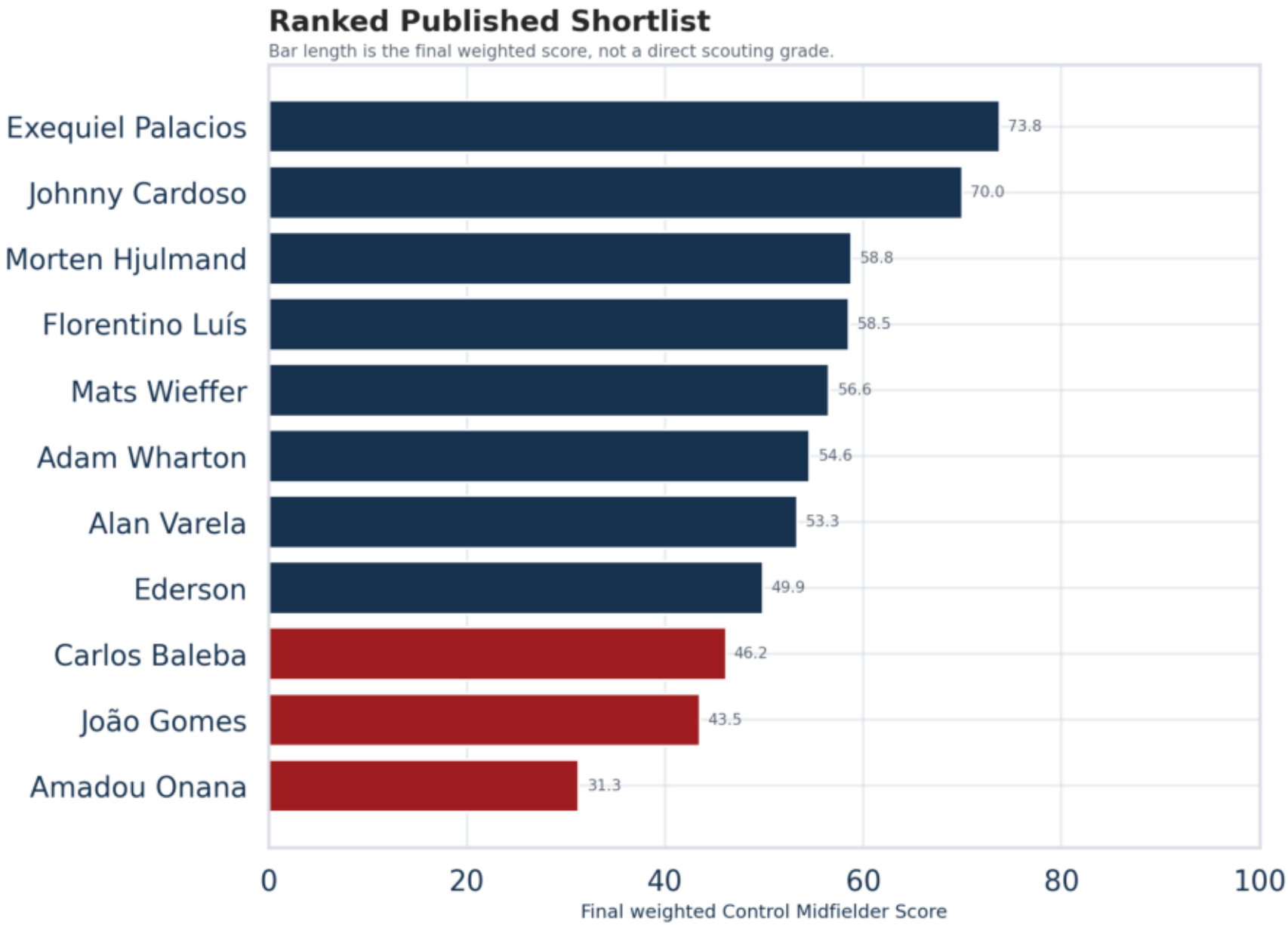
The next signing should not only win duels. It should prevent some of them from happening.

This is a public-data recruitment screen for Manchester United's midfield-control problem.
It is not proprietary scouting data and it is not a signing verdict.

Palacios leads the weighted screen as a possession-control candidate. Cardoso is the cleaner two-axis defensive/security fit. Borderline names should be reviewed through video, tactical role context, league translation, and availability work.

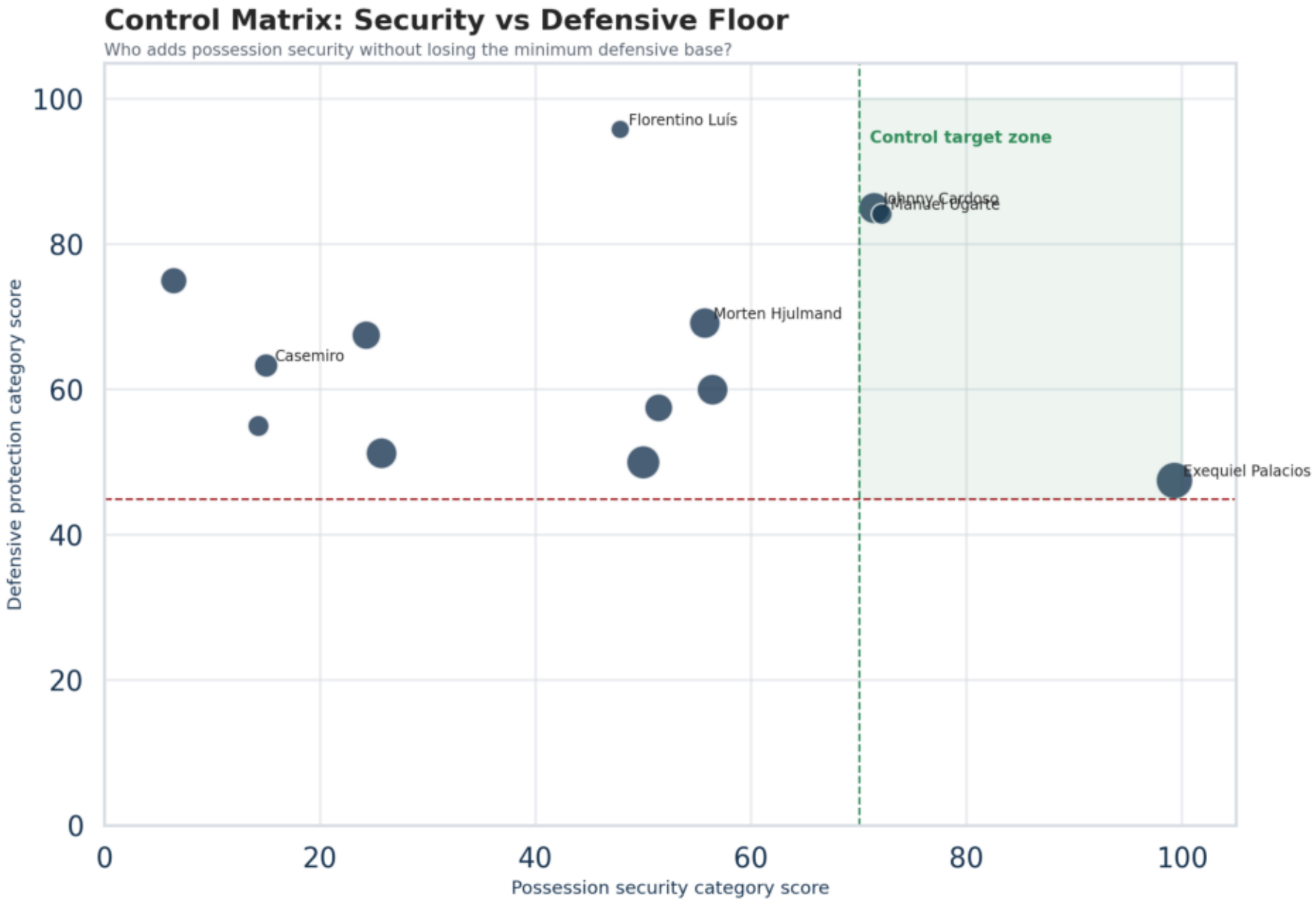
Ranked Published Shortlist

The bar length is the final weighted score, not a direct scouting grade.



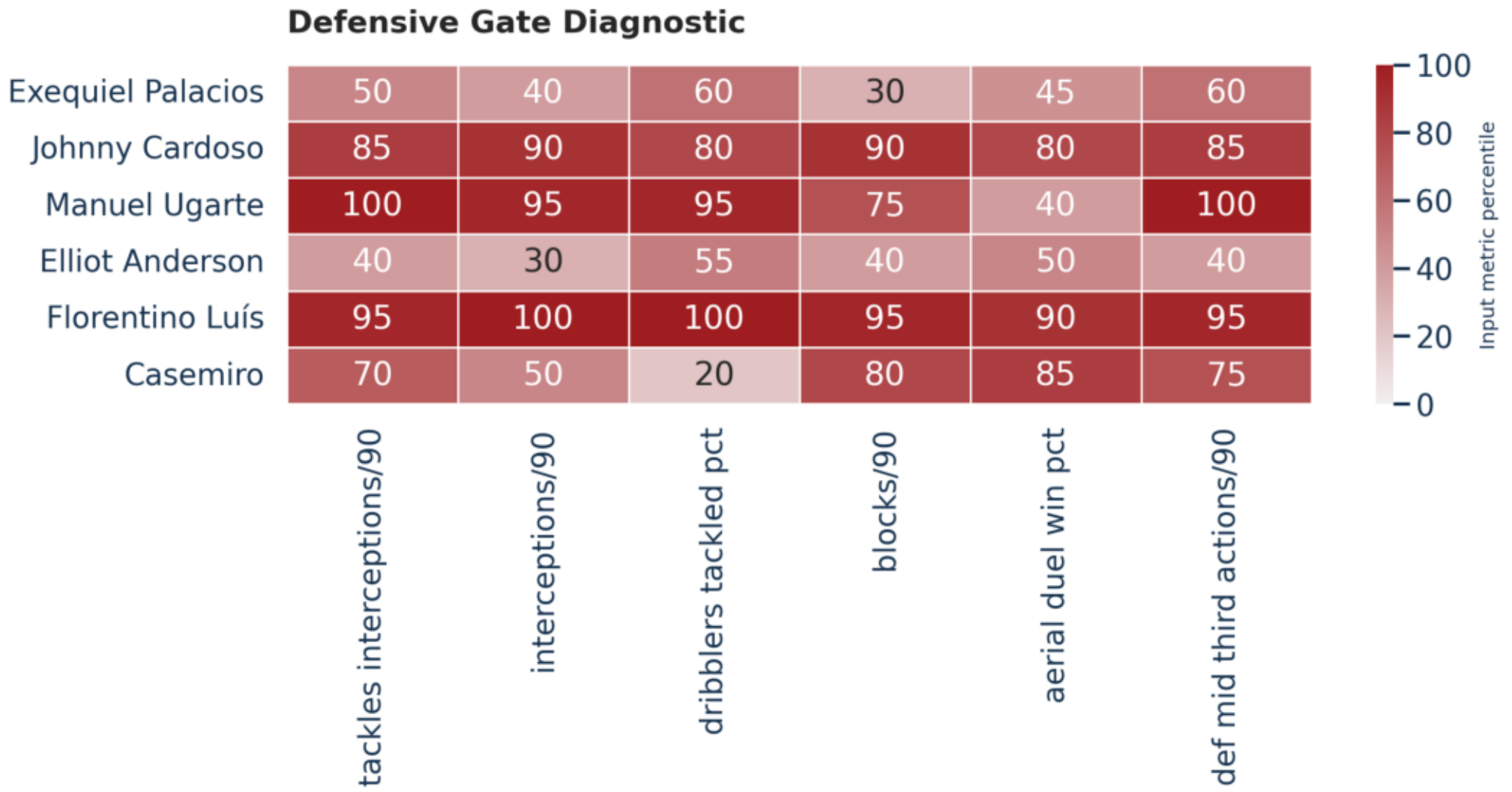
Control Matrix

This shows the main trade-off: who adds possession security without losing the minimum defensive base?



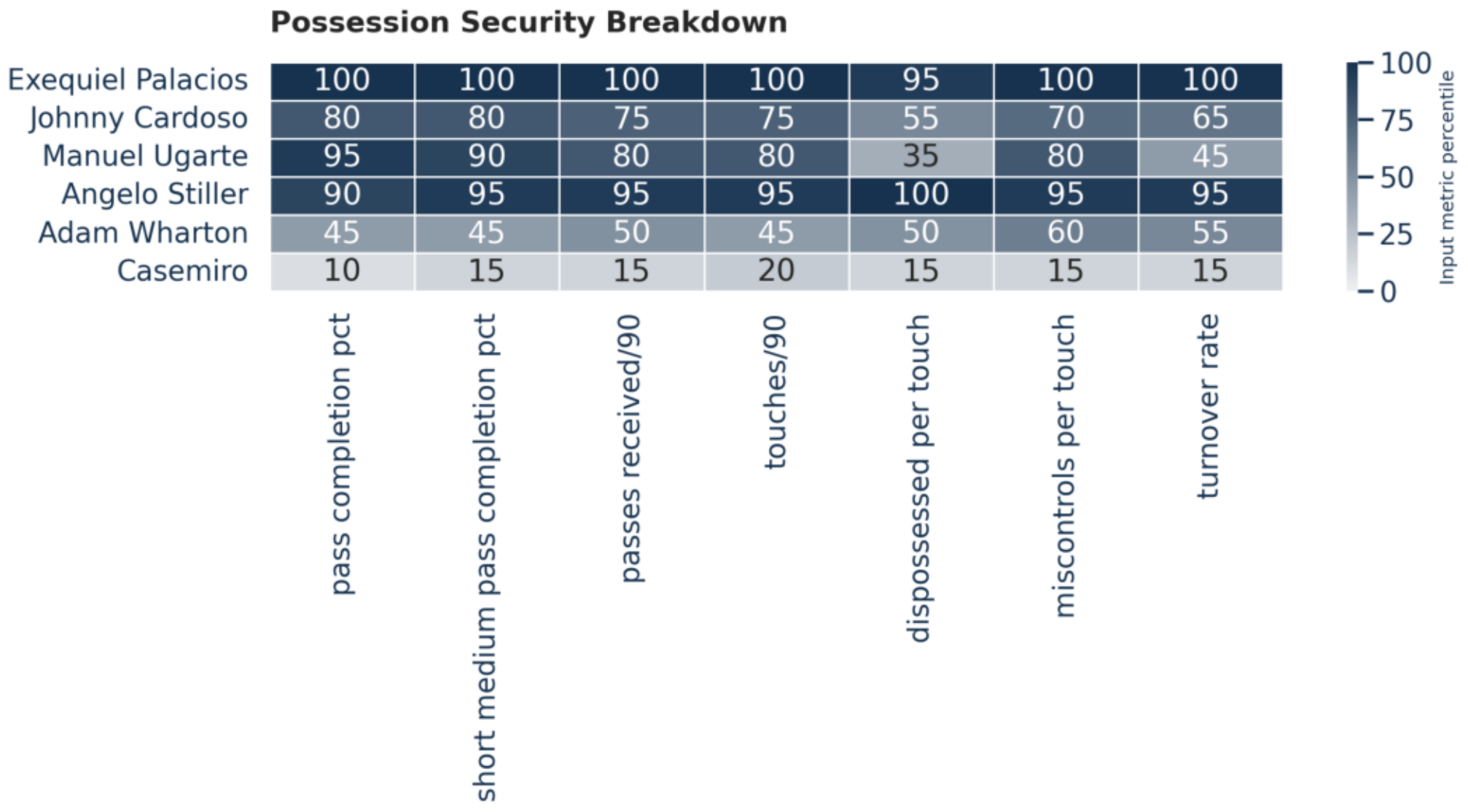
Defensive Gate Diagnostic

The Palacios-Anderson gap is narrow enough that borderline cases should be video-tested rather than treated as definitive.



Possession Security Breakdown

This separates safe passers from players who are available, involved, and secure under volume.

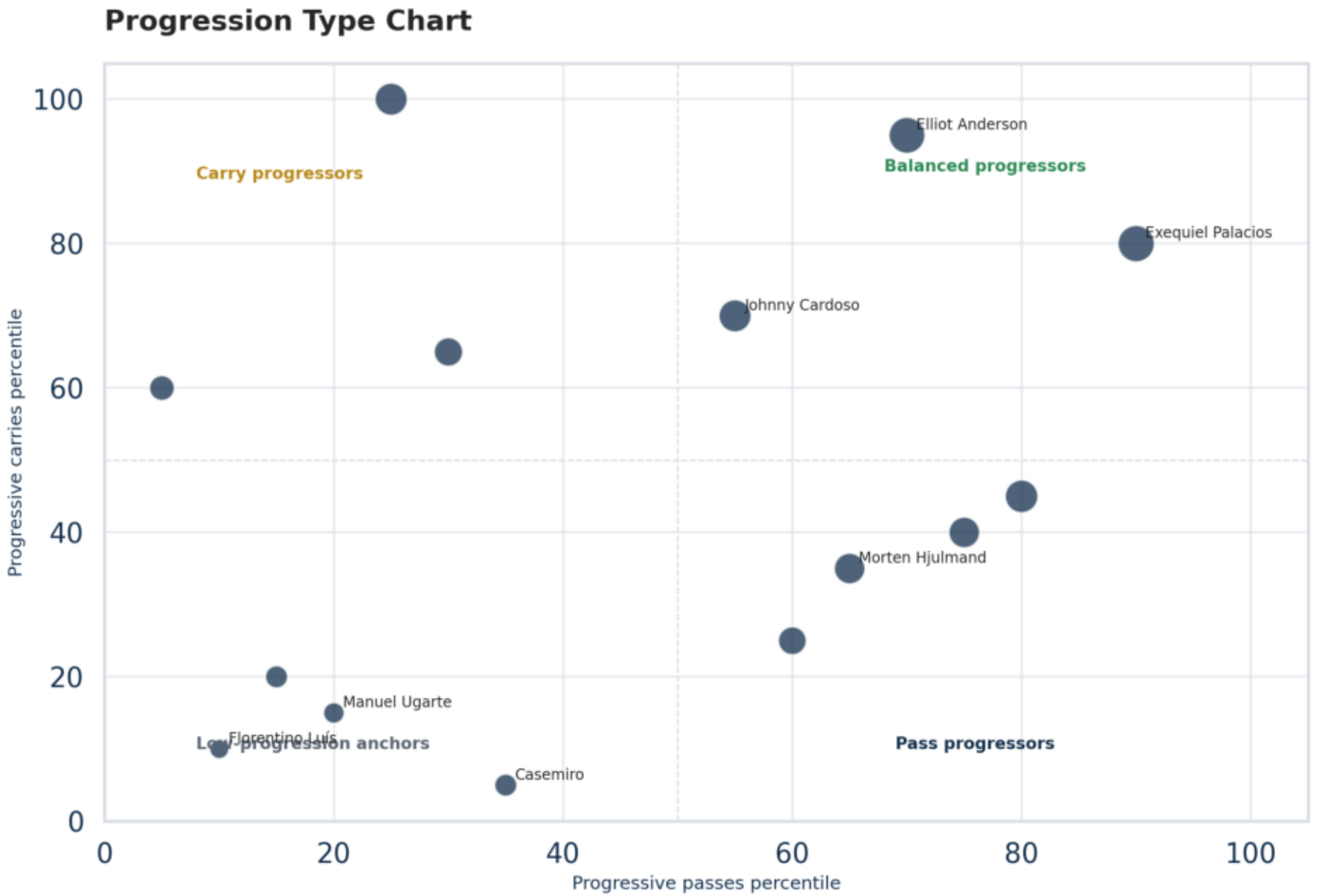


Transition Chaos Map

United's issue is not only ball-winning; it is the number of unstable moments after possession breaks.

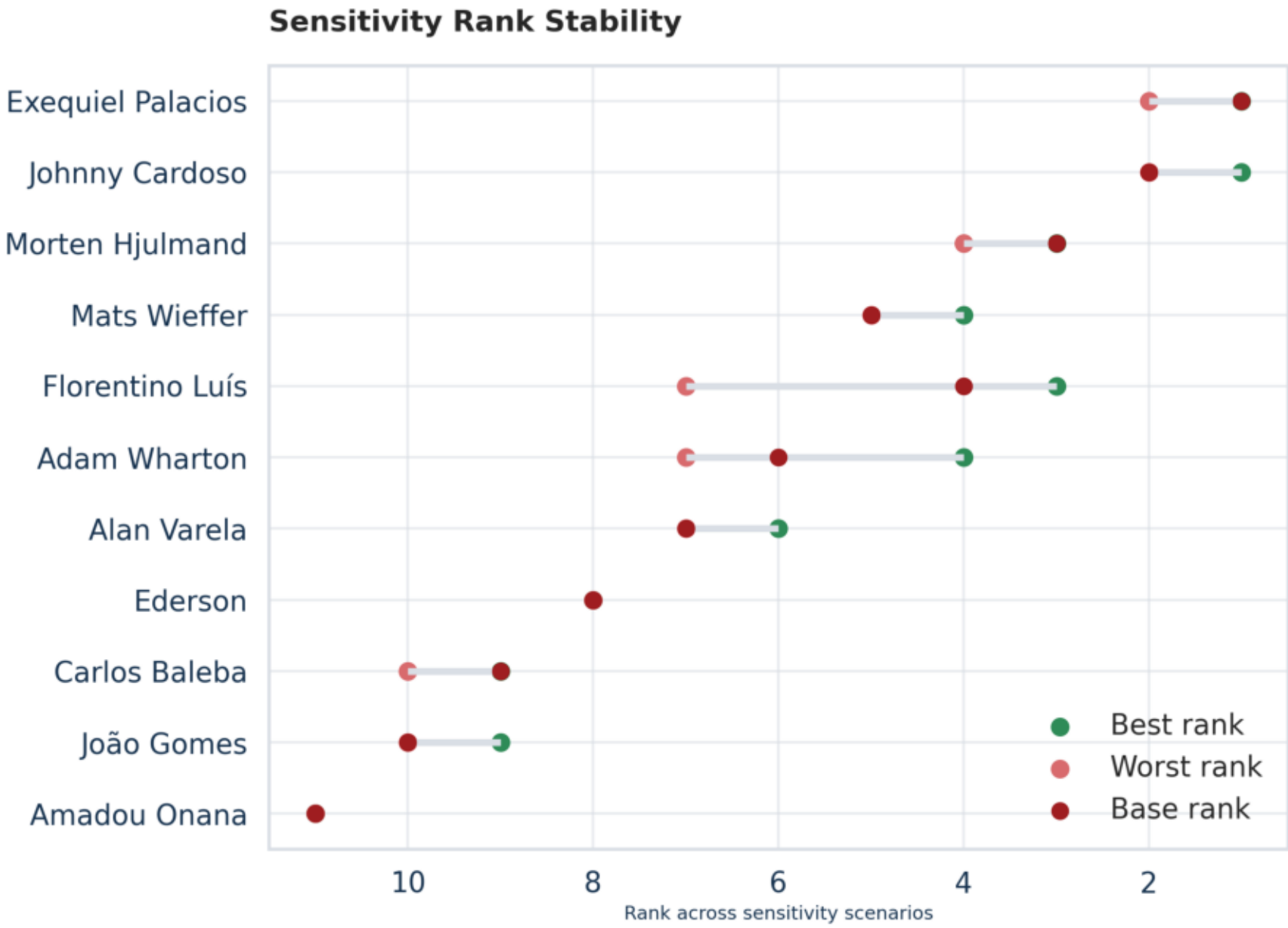
Progression Type Chart

Progression is not one skill: some players progress through passing, others through carrying.



Sensitivity Rank Stability

Robust candidates remain near the top under several reasonable weighting assumptions.



Shortlist Table

The table is constrained to core columns to avoid overflow and keep the PDF readable.

rank	player	squad	control_midfielder_	defensive_protecti	transition_control	possession_securit	progressive_value	gate_margin
1	Exequiel Palacios	Bayer Leverkusen	73.8	47.5	79.3	99.3	85.8	2.5
2	Johnny Cardoso	Atletico Madrid	70.0	85.0	63.6	71.4	57.5	40.0
3	Morten Hjulmand	Sporting CP	58.8	69.2	51.1	55.7	55.0	24.2
4	Florentino Luís	Burnley	58.5	95.8	59.3	47.9	8.3	50.8
5	Mats Wieffer	Brighton & Hove Albi	56.6	60.0	52.9	56.4	55.8	15.0
6	Adam Wharton	Crystal Palace	54.6	50.0	61.4	50.0	67.5	5.0
7	Alan Varela	Porto	53.3	57.5	57.9	51.4	42.5	12.5
8	Ederson	Atalanta	49.9	67.5	52.9	24.3	45.0	22.5
9	Carlos Baleba	Brighton & Hove Albi	46.2	51.2	50.7	25.7	55.8	6.2
10	João Gomes	Wolverhampton Wan	43.6	75.0	44.3	6.4	35.8	30.0
11	Amadou Onana	Aston Villa	31.3	55.0	25.0	14.3	16.7	10.0

Archetype Summary

Archetypes translate the model output into plain-English scouting priorities.

player	final_score	archetype_label	strongest_category	weakest_category	gate_margin
Exequiel Palacios	73.8	Control profile	possession_security	age_availability	2.5
Johnny Cardoso	70.0	Two-axis defensive/security fit	defensive_protection	age_availability	40.0
Manuel Ugarte	61.7	Two-axis defensive/security fit	defensive_protection	progressive_value	39.2
Elliot Anderson	61.7	Removed by defensive gate	progressive_value	defensive_protection	-2.5
Morten Hjulmand	58.8	Watchlist / role-context needed	defensive_protection	transition_control	24.2
Florentino Luís	58.5	Defensive-floor anchor	defensive_protection	progressive_value	50.8
Angelo Stiller	56.7	Removed by defensive gate	possession_security	defensive_protection	-36.7
Mats Wieffer	56.6	Watchlist / role-context needed	defensive_protection	transition_control	15.0
Adam Wharton	54.6	Watchlist / role-context needed	progressive_value	age_availability	5.0
Hugo Larsson	54.3	Removed by defensive gate	possession_security	defensive_protection	-6.2
Alan Varela	53.3	Watchlist / role-context needed	transition_control	progressive_value	12.5
Aleix Garcia	53.2	Removed by defensive gate	possession_security	defensive_protection	-38.3

Watchlist Removed by Defensive Gate

Below-gate players are not deleted from the analysis; they are moved to video/context review.

player	squad	control_midfielder_score	defensive_protection	gate_margin
Elliot Anderson	Nottingham Forest	61.7	42.5	-2.5
Angelo Stiller	Stuttgart	56.7	8.3	-36.7
Hugo Larsson	Eintracht Frankfurt	54.3	38.8	-6.2
Aleix Garcia	Bayer Leverkusen	53.2	6.7	-38.3
Samuele Ricci	AC Milan	49.2	28.8	-16.2
Bruno Guimarães	Newcastle United	47.9	27.5	-17.5
Youssouf Fofana	AC Milan	38.2	36.2	-8.8

Sensitivity Summary

Rank stability indicates whether the shortlist depends too heavily on one subjective weighting choice.

player	rank_base	rank_defensive_heavy	rank_possession_heavy	rank_range	rank_stability_score
Exequiel Palacios	1	2	1	1	75.0
Johnny Cardoso	2	1	2	1	75.0
Morten Hjulmand	3	4	3	1	75.0
Mats Wieffer	5	5	4	1	75.0
Florentino Luís	4	3	5	4	0.0
Adam Wharton	6	7	6	3	25.0
Alan Varela	7	6	7	1	75.0
Ederson	8	8	8	0	100.0
Carlos Baleba	9	10	9	1	75.0
João Gomes	10	9	10	1	75.0
Amadou Onana	11	11	11	0	100.0